

That was the end of the story. We'd shake our heads at how peculiar some people can be. I always had the impression that my uncle could pretty much figure things out. But how people in Ohio can choose to stay where they are was something he never understood.

When I was a little older I lived briefly—but not briefly enough—in Grand Rapids, Michigan. I observed firsthand what my uncle had described. I decided to ask people why they lived there. Maybe I could enlighten my uncle after all those years.

To my surprise, I found that most people had never thought about why they lived where they lived. After some stammering they'd glare at me and say, "We've lived here a long time."

So why *do* you live where you live? Chapter 4 focused on the huge amounts you pay for housing. This chapter talks of how and where you can live for less. To retire you must control your living costs. To control your living costs you must know what you need in terms of living space. To start you thinking about it, I've prepared a list of questions. Choose the answers that best describe your present situation.

1. What do you like most about your living room?
 - a. There's a cozy, well-lit reading chair.
 - b. There's a comfortable seating area to chat with friends.
 - c. It shows off your expensive furniture and paintings.
 - d. A B-1 bomber could fit nicely in the corner.
 - e. You can't answer because you haven't found it yet.
2. What is the ratio of telephones to televisions in your home?
 - a. One to one.
 - b. Two to two.
 - c. It depends on whether you include broken phones and black-and-white televisions.
 - d. You're not sure you can find them all.
 - e. You can't figure it out because higher math is your weak suit.